

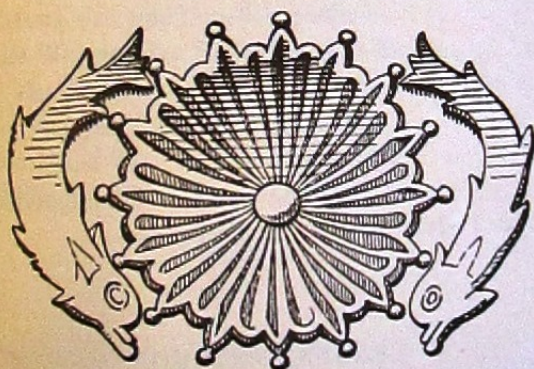
BULLETIN

DE LA

SOCIÉTÉ D'ARCHÉOLOGIE COPTE

TOME XV

(1958-1960)



LE CAIRE

IMPRIMERIE DE L'INSTITUT FRANÇAIS D'ARCHÉOLOGIE ORIENTALE

MCMLX

A DISCOURSE BY ST. JOHN CHRYSOSTOM ON THE SINFUL WOMAN IN THE SA'IDIC DIALECT

BY

Y. 'ABD AL-MASĪH

The Pierpont Morgan Collection of Coptic MSS., t. LIII, Codex, 577, ff. 26^r-35^r, contains a discourse attributed to St. John Chrysostom on the Sinful Woman. The text of this discourse is not the same as the Greek text of St. John Chrysostom's discourse on the Sinful Woman, printed in Migne's Collection, P. G. t. LXI(X) Coll. 727-754, which is entitled, *Eis τὸν Φαρισαῖον καὶ εἰς τὴν πόρνην*. «On the Pharisee and the Sinful Woman», and begins: «Ἄπας μὲν καιρὸς παντὶ βουλομένῳ πρὸς μετάνοιαν ἐπιτήδειος ἔξεστί γὰρ ἐκάστω θελήσαντι καὶ ἐν τῷ ἔαρι βλασφήσαι τὴν εὐζωίαν. «Every time, indeed, is suitable for all who have a wish for repentance, for it is necessary for everyone who so wishes to put forth buds of a good life even in the spring», and ends on Col. 754: Ἀφένονται ὑμῶν αἱ ἁμαρτίαι θαρσεῖτε, τέκνα, ἡ πίστις ὑμῶν σέσωκεν ὑμᾶς, καὶ τὴν πίστιν ἐκείνης ταῖς ἡμετέραις ἐννοίαις ἐγγράψωμεν δόξαν, ἀναπέμποντες τῷ πατρὶ καὶ υἱῷ κ.τ.λ. «Children, be of good courage, your sins are forgiven, your faith hath saved you. Let us also inscribe on our minds the faith of that woman, sending up glory to the Father and to the Son, etc.» Nor is it the same as the Mimar in Arabic on «The Sinful Woman» attributed to St. John Chrysostom, which is found in MS. No. 92 Lit. of the church of Kašriyat ar-Riḥān, Old Cairo. This MS. contains Mimars for Lent and Holy Week. The Mimar in question occupies ff. 104^r-112^r and is entitled on f. 104^r *مير قاله القديس يوحنا فم الذهب على الامراة الخاطية من الصوم المقدس يقرى باكر يوم الجمعة السادسة من الصوم المقدس*.

«A Mimar which was pronounced by St. John Chrysostom on the Sinful Woman, and it is read at the Morning (Offering of Incense) on the Friday of the 6th. Week of Lent (the Holy Fast)».

من الواجب ايها الاخوة حرسكم الله بكل معنى وبكل وجه وكل سبب
استقبال الوارد وتاديبه الكرامة له لان هذا هو المعترف عند سائر الناس .

«It is obligatory, my brethren, — may God watch over you with all solicitude and in all ways and by all means —, to receive the visitor and to bestow upon him honour, since this is the custom amongst all peoples.»

Exp. 112'.

مؤهلين لما اهلته له هذه الفاضلة التي ذكر خطاياها صار سبباً للغفران والخلص...
«We are worthy of what this excellent (woman) merited, the mention of whose sins became the cause of forgiveness and salvation, etc.»⁽¹⁾.

The MS. is dated (f. 234'), the 19th Amsir A. M. 1461 which corresponds to the 22nd Muharram A. H. 1158 (A. D. 1765). It was copied by the priest Šalib, minister of the Church of the Virgin Mary al-'Adawiyah العديوية i.e. Ma'ādī, south of Cairo.

I thank my friend Dr. Burmester for his kind help and suggestions.

Old Cairo 5th Hatūr A. M. 1675

15th November A. D. 1958

YASSA 'ABD-AL-MASIH

⁽¹⁾ This Homily is also attributed to St. Ephraem. Cf. G. GRAY, *Geach. der christl. arab. Literatur*, t. I, Città del Vaticano, 1944, p. 346, n. 2.

THE TEXT

t. LIII. Codex M. 577

*ΟΥΛΟΓΟΣ ΕΛΑ-
ΤΑΥΟΝ ΗΣΙΔΠΑ
ΙΩΣΑΝΗΝΣ ΠΑΡ-
ΧΙΕΠΙΣΚΟΠΟΣ
ΗΚΩΣΤΑΝΤΙ-
ΝΟΥΠΟΛΙΣ · ΕΤ-
ΕΤΕΣΖΙΜΕ ΠΡΕΦ-
ΝΟΒΕ ΗΤΑΣΜΕΤΑ-
ΝΟΙ · ΗΤΑΣ-
ΗΠΕΣΟΥΟΙ ΕΙΣ ΖΗ-
ΝΗ ΗΠΕΦΑΡΙΣ-
ΣΑΙΟΣ · ΛΥΧΑΡΙΖΕ
ΠΑΣ ΗΠΚΩ ΕΒΟΛ
ΗΠΕΣΠΟΚΕ · ΕΦΙ-
ΡΟΤΡΕΠΕ ΠΟΥΟΝ
ΗΙΝ ΕΖΟΥΗ ΕΤΜΕ-
ΤΑΝΒΑ · ΛΥΩ
ΧΕΙΠΕΠΡΩΜΕ
ΜΟΥΣ ΗΤΑΝΟΜΙΑ
ΖΗΟΥΕΙΡΗΝΗ
ΗΤΕΠΠΟΥΤΕ ΖΑ-
ΜΗΝ · —

ΑΝΗΤΗ ΠΕΝ-
ΤΑΝΕΥΖΗΡΕ
ΕΡΟΦΕΡ ΕΒΟΛ-ΖΗ-
ΤΗΝΤΑΤΚΑΡ-
ΠΟΣ ΜΠΛΘΟΣ
ΠΑΙ ΕΤ-ΦΑΡΒΑ Ε-

ΖΟΥΗ ΕΖΑΥ· ΗΤΕ-
ΤΗΦΩΝΤ ΠΗ-
ΤΗ ΗΣΕΠΚΑΟΝ ·
ΕΒΟΛ ΖΗΠΝΑΠ-
ΦΗΝ · ΗΠΕΥΑΓ-
ΓΕΛΙΟΝ · —

ΑΝΗΤΗ ΠΕΝΤΑ-
ΠΕΥΛΑΜΠΑΣ ΧΕ-
ΠΑ ΖΗΤΗΠΕΣΤΟΜ-
ΤΗ · ΜΠΚΑΚΕ ΗΤ-
ΜΠΤΑΣΕΒΗΣ ΗΤΕ-
ΤΙΧΗΓΖ ΠΗΤΗ ·
ΖΗΠΠΕΖ ΗΤΜΕ
ΤΑΝΟΙΑ · —

ΑΝΗΤΗ Φ ΠΕΤ-
ΦΤΡΤΩΡ ΖΗΠΕ-
ΧΙΜΩΠ ΠΜΠΑ-
ΘΟΣ · ΗΤΕΤΗ-
ΤΑΧΡΕΤΗΥΤΗ ·
ΖΗΠΖΑΥΒΑΛ Η-
ΠΕΥΑΓΓΕΛΙΟΝ · —

† ΗΠΕΤΗΟΥΟΙ · ΛΧΗ-
ΖΟΤΕ ΕΖΟΥΗ ΕΤ-
ΜΕΤΑΝΟΙΑ ΣΟΒ-
ΤΕ ΠΗΤΗ ΗΤΕΖΗ ·
ΖΗΟΥΤΑΧΡΟ · —

ΗΠΕΡΤΡΕΛΑΥ ·

*Fol. 26 R
ΠΠ

Fol. 26 V
[n]

ΧΗΛΑΥ · ΕΨ̅ ΗΠΕΥ ·
*ΟΥΟΙ ΕΖΟΥΗ ΕΤΗΕ ·
ΤΑΝΟΙΑ · —

Μπερωϊνε ΧΕΛΑ ·
ΕΡΗΟΚΕ · ΖΕΠΗΟΕ
ΜΗΝΤΩΨΗΤΗΙ
ΜΠΟΥΤΕ · ΠΖΟΥΟ
ΕΝΕΚΗΟΚΕ · —

Μπερχοος ΧΕΛΙ ·
ΩΜΕ ΖΗΝΗΤΑ ·
ΣΕΚΗΕ · —

ΟΥΨΧΟΙ ΓΑΡ ΕΛΥΕΝ ·
ΤΕ ΕΖΑΪ · ΜΗΨΑ ·
ΕΤΡΕΧΩΜΕ · —

ΖΩΚ ΜΗ ΕΤΟΥΝΑ ·
ΣΠΟΥΛΑΖΕ ΕΡΩ ·
ΨΑΧΩΚ ΕΒΟΛ
ΖΗΟΥΣΟΟΥΤΗ · —

Ερετεςπουαν ΓΑΡ ·
ΟΥΝΕ ΨΑΤΕΠΡΟ ·
ΖΑΪΡΕΣΙΕ · —

ΟΥΜΑΪΩΜΕ ΓΑΡ
ΕΠΕΖΟΥΟΤΕ ΤΗΕ ·
ΤΑΝΟΙΑ · —

ΣΚΩΤΕ ΖΗΝΗΪ Η ·
ΝΕΤΩΨΗΕ · ΣΕΕ ·
ΡΑΠΕΥΕ ΨΜΟΥ · —

ΣΚΩΤΕ ΖΗΝΕΤΟ ·
ΠΟΣ ΨΠΕΤΕΖΗ ·
ΕΣ ΕΣΟΛΑ ΨΜΟΥ · —

ΣΨΜΑΛΑΚΜΑ · —
ΣΕΡΑΠΕΥΕ ΨΨΑΛ
ΨΤΑΥΕΡΖΑΛΕΤΗ
ΖΗΤΓΑΚΙΑ · —

ΣΨΩΨΗΕ ΜΗΚΑΖ
ΨΤΑΥΕΡΜΕΛΑΖΕ ·
ΖΗΤΣΩΨΕ ΕΤ ·
ΧΗΚ ΕΒΟΛ ΨΡΕΥ ·
ΨΚΑΡΠΟΣ · —

ΧΕΨΠΕΝΩΣΚ
ΖΗΨΑΧΕ ΕΠΕ ·
ΖΟΥΟ · ΖΗΠΕΨΡΟΪ ·
ΜΙΟΗ · —

ΛΥΕΙΣ ΨΤΕΠΧΩ
ΨΗΤΪ ΨΠΕΝΤΑΥ ·
ΩΨΟΥ ΤΕΠΟΥ · —

ΨΤΕΠΟΥΨΗΪ ΨΗ ·
ΤΪ ΕΒΟΛ · ΨΤΕΟΗ
ΨΤΜΕΤΑΠΟΙΑ

ΜΑΛΛΩΗ ΛΕ Ψ ·
ΤΕΠΣΥΜΑΠΕ ΨΗ ·
ΤΪ ΨΤΜΪΤΜΑΪ ·
ΡΩΜΕ ΨΠΠΟΥΤΕ

ΛΟΥΧ ΛΕ ΨΠΕΦΑ ·
ΡΙΣΣΑΙΟΣ ΕΨΩΠΪ
ΧΕΨΕΨΟΥΨΗ ΨΪ ·
ΜΑΧ · —

ΠΡΩΜΕ ΚΩΨΩ
ΕΨΠΟΥΤΕ · —

ΨΤΑΜΙΟ ΕΨΕΟΠΕ
ΨΨΡΕΨΤΑΜΙΟ
ΕΨΩΚ ΕΖΟΥΗ ΕΠΕΥ ·
*ΨΪ · ΑΠΠΟΥΤΕ

ΟΥΨΗ ΜΨΡΩ ·
ΜΕ · —

ΑΠΛΥΜΙΟΥΡΓΟΣ ΟΥ ·
ΩΗ ΜΨΡΕΨΕΡ ·
ΠΟΚΕ · ΧΕΚΑΣ ΕΨΕ ·
ΤΩΨΪ ΨΠΕΡΕΥ ·
ΕΡΗΟΚΕ ΕΨΜΕΤΑ ·
ΠΟΙΑ · —

ΜΠΕΠΠΟΥΤΕ ΨΕΟ
ΕΨΩΚ ΕΖΟΥΗ ΕΠΪ
ΜΨΡΕΨΕΡΗΟΚΕ ·
ΨΤΑΨΕΪ ΡΩ ΕΤ ·
ΚΨΗΤΪ · —

ΛΟΥΚ ΛΕ ΕΖΟΥΗ
ΕΠΪ ΜΠΕΦΑ ·
ΡΙΣΣΑΙΟΣ ΑΨΠΟΧΪ · —

ΑΨΠΟΥΤΕ ΕΩΚ
ΕΖΟΥΗ ΕΠΪ ΜΨ ·
ΡΩΜΕ · —

ΑΛΛΑ ΟΥ ΠΕΤΩΟ ·
ΟΠ ΖΗΠΪ ΜΨΡΩ ·
ΜΕ ΧΕΨΠΟΥΪ ΑΨ ·
ΜΕ · ΠΕΤ ·

ΣΑΨΩ ΕΨΤΨΡΪ ·
ΑΨΟΥΨΗ ΠΟΥΤ ·

ΡΟΨΗ ΠΕΛΑ ·
ΧΙΣΤΟΠ · —

Πετερεναλγελαος
ΑΪΑΚΟΗ ΕΪ ΕΡΩ ·
ΑΥΑΪΑΚΟΗ ΕΪ ΕΡΩ ·
ΨΠΠΕΨΜΑΛ Μ ·
ΠΕΦΑΡΙΣΣΑΙΟΣ ·
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ΜΠΕΦΑΡΙΣΣΑΙΟΣ ·
ΑΨ · ΠΕΤΕΪΡΕ ΨΤ ·
ΜΪΤΜΑΪΡΩΜΕ ·
ΜΨΠΠΟΥΤΕ ΑΛ ·
ΑΛ ΠΠΟΥΤΕ ΠΕΤ
ΦΪΛΛΗΨΡΟΠΗ ·
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ΠΡΩΜΕ ΚΩ ΕΖΑΪ
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ΤΟΥ · —

ΛΥΕΙΣ ΨΤΕΠΨΗ ·
ΠΕΠΟΥΟΪ · ΕΖΟΥΗ
ΕΨΠΠΕ ΨΟΥΣΑΥΤΟΣ ·
ΠΑΪ ΕΤΟ ΠΑΪ ΠΟΥ
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ΤΜΕΤΑΠΟΙΑ · —

ΕΙΣ ΟΥΨΪΜΕ ΛΕ Ψ ·
ΡΕΨΕΡΗΟΚΕ ΕΨΠΕΠ ·
ΤΠΟΧΙΕ · ΨΤΕΡΕΨ ·

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ΖΗΠΪ ΜΠΕΦΑ ·

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 ΜΟΟΥ ΖΗΟΥΖΥ-
 ΔΩΝΗ · ΛΣ-
 ΦΟΥΘ ΕΠΕΣΗΤ
 ΠΟΥΛΩΝ ΠΡΗΕΙΝ ·
 *ΕΒΟΛ ΝΗΝΤΟΥ : —

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[ΠΔ]

ΑΝΝΑΥ ΕΤΕΣΣΕΙΝ-
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ΑΚΟΕΩΡΕΙ ΝΤΕΣΠ-
 ΡΟΖΑΙΡΕΣΙΣ ΕΣΧΟ-
 ΣΕ : ΑΝΑΥ

ΕΠΟΥΦΩΝΗΖΗΤ ·
 ΜΗΠΙΖΗΚΕ · ΑΥΩ
 ΠΩΚΗ ΝΤΕΣ-
 ΦΥΧΗ · ΧΕΛΑΚΑ-
 ΤΑΣΤΙΛΕ ΝΟΥ-
 ΗΡ ΜΠΑΘΟΣ : —

ΕΠΜΑ ΝΟΥΧΗΡ ·
 ΜΠΟΥΣΩΒΕ · Η-
 ΤΑΤΑΙΘΕΝΠΕΙΟΥ-
 ΩΦΗ ΜΦΥΧΗ
 ΝΤΩΝ : —

ΗΤΑΝΕΙΩΚΗ ΕΙ
 ΕΒΟΛ ΖΙΤΗΤΕ-
 ΤΑΝΟΙΑ : —

ΚΗΛΥ ΧΕΦΑΡΕ-
 ΟΥΧΗΡ · ΜΠΟΥ-

ΕΒΟΛ ΕΒΟΛ ΦΩ-
 ΠΕ ΖΗΟΥΖΥΔΩ-
 ΝΗ : ΑΝΑΥ
 ΖΩΦΩ ΕΠΕΣΕ-
 ΡΑΖΤ ΜΗΤΚΑ-
 ΤΑΣΤΑΣΙΣ · ΕΤΕ-
 ΦΑΣΦΩΠΕ ΖΙ-
 ΤΗΤΜΕΤΑΝΕΛ : —

ΑΣΛΕ ΕΡΑΤΕ ΖΙΠΑ-
 ΖΟΥ ΜΜΟΧ ΖΑ-
 ΡΑΤΕ ⁽¹⁾ ΕΣΡΙΜΕ · ΛΣ-
 ΑΡΧΕΙ ΝΖΩΡΗ
 ΝΠΕΦΟΥΕΡΙΤΕ
 ΖΗΠΕΡΜΕΙΘΟΥΕ : —

ΤΑΙΤΕ ΤΑΡΧΗ Η-
 ΤΕΣΟΕΣΙΣ : —

ΤΑΙΤΕ ΤΕΠΗΚΗ
 ΝΤΕΦΥΧΗ Ε-
 ΖΟΥΝ ΕΤΗΜΕΤΑ-
 ΝΟΙΑ : —

ΤΑΙΤΕ ΤΑΡΧΗ
 ΝΤΕΠΟΥΩΝΗ
 ΕΒΟΛ · ΝΤΕΠΡΟ-
 ΖΑΙΡΕΣΙΣ : —

ΝΕΡΜΕΙΘΟΥΕ ΣΩΚ
 ΕΠΕΣΗΤ ΕΧΗ-
 ΠΕΣΟΥΘΕ · ΜΗ-
 ΠΑΦΑΖΟΜ : —

⁽¹⁾ Sic, read ΖΑΡΑΤΑ.

ΝΕ ΜΗΤΑΣΠΑΡΡΗ-
 ΣΙΑ ΜΗΑΥ ΕΦΑ-
 ΧΕ Η ΕΟΥΩΝ
 ΝΡΩΣ : —

ΑΛΛΑ ΕΝΕΣΕΒΕΤ
 ΜΜΑΤΕ ΖΗΟΥ-
 ΜΗΤΕΒΙΝΗ ·
 ΕΣΑΦΑΖΟΜ · ΑΥΩ ·
 *ΕΣΡΙΜΕ : —

ΤΕΦΥΧΗ ΓΑΡ ΕΤ-
 ΠΑΦ ΜΠΕΣΟΥ-
 ΟΙ ΕΠΠΟΥΤΕ ΖΗ-
 ΟΥΜΕ ΜΕΣ-
 ΦΠΕ ΕΡΩΛΗ-
 ΠΡΩΜΕ ΝΑΥ
 ΕΡΟΣ ΕΣΡΙΜΕ ΕΣ-
 ΖΙΟΥΕ ΕΖΟΥΝ ΖΗ-
 ΤΕΣΜΕΣΤΗΖΗΤ ·
 ΖΑΠΛΩΛΙ ΝΠΕΝ-
 ΤΑΣΑΛΥ ΕΣΤΩΛΚ
 ΕΒΟΛ ΜΠΕΣΚΩ

ΦΑΣΕΙ ΖΑΠΕΧ-
 ΠΙΟ ΖΗΟΥΛΠ-
 ΑΝ ΕΣΟΚΚΗΝΥ ·

ΕΥΦΑΝΑΠΙΑΝ
 ΕΧΩΣ ΜΕΣΕΩΝΤ
 ΑΛΛΑ ΦΑΡΕΝΕ-
 ΟΘΟΥ ΚΟΛΑΖΕ Μ-
 ΜΟΣ : —

ΦΑΣΧΠΙΟΣ ΜΗΝ
 ΜΜΟΣ :

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ΦΑΣΕΝΑΡΚΕ Ε-
 ΤΕΣΣΥΝΙΑΝ-
 ΣΙΣ : —

ΦΑΣΧΟΟΣ ΧΕΤΕΜ-
 ΠΩΛ ΝΖΙΣΕ ΜΗ
 ΜΕΦΑΚ ΖΙΤΗΠΑΙ
 ΦΗΛΩΧΕ Η-
 ΠΑΠΑΡΑΠΤΩ-
 ΜΑ ΠΟΥΚΟΥΙ

ΠΑΙ ΔΕΠΕ ΠΜΑ-
 ΕΙΝ · ΧΕΛΠΡΩΜΕ
 ΚΤΟΥ ΕΒΟΛ ΖΗ-
 ΠΕΚΠΟΒΕ

ΖΟΤΑΝ ΕΦΩΛΗ-
 ΦΕΙ ΖΑΠΕΧΠΙΟ
 ΖΗΟΥΛΑΙ : —

ΝΕΤΟΥΩΜ ΔΕ Η-
 ΣΑΠΕΧΠΙΟ ΟΥΛ-
 ΘΗΤΠΕ ΑΥΩ
 ΦΟΝΗΤ ΣΠΛΥ
 ΑΥΩ ΦΩΤΡΤΩΡ
 ΖΗΠΕΖΙΘΟΥΕ
 ΤΗΡΟΥ : —

ΕΚΩΛΠΕΡΩΠΗ-
 ΡΕ ΝΤΕΙΝΤΕΣ-
 ΟΥΘΙ ΕΠΠΟΥΤΕ
 ΑΡΙΩΠΗΡΕ ΕΠΕ-
 ΖΟΥΟ ΝΤΗΜΙΤ-
 ΜΑΙΡΩΜΕ ΜΠ-
 ΠΟΥΤΕ

ΑΣΑΡΧΕΙ ΝΖΩΡΗ
 ΝΠΕΦΟΥΕΡΙΤΕ

Fol. 29 R

ΠΩ

αὐτοῦ ἐν ἡ
ἐν ἡ

Ἀποστολὴν ἡ

* Fol. 29 V
[10]

* ὡς ἐξ ἡ
νοὲς ἐν ἡ
νοὲς ἡ
αὐτῶς ἐν ἡ
ρογραφῶν : —

Ἀποστολὴν ἡ
περὶ τῶν περ-
σῶν ἡ

† ἡ ἐν ἡ
ἐν ἡ
ἐν ἡ
ἐν ἡ

Ἀποστολὴν ἡ
ἐν ἡ
ἐν ἡ
ἐν ἡ
ἐν ἡ
ἐν ἡ
ἐν ἡ
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* Fol. 30 B
[11]

ΠΕΤΗΝΥ ΦΑΡΟΪ
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*ΕΚΟΛ ΣΙΤΟΟΤ · ΕΥ-
[x] ΤΕΝΗΥ · —

ΒΙΣ ΤΕΚΤΑΠΡΟ ΖΟ-
ΜΟΛΟΓΕΪ Ω ΣΙΜΩΝ ·
ΧΕΠΕΤΦΑΥΚΑ-
ΖΑΣ ΝΑΥ ΕΒΟΛ · Ω-
ΦΕ ΕΡΟΥ ΕΤΡΕΥ-
ΜΕ ΕΠΕΖΟΥΘ · —

ΚΑΪΡΙΝΕ ΜΕΝ ΖΗ-
ΤΕΚΤΑΠΡΟ ΖΗ-
ΟΥΣΟΥΤΗ ΚΚΑ-
ΚΟΛΟΓΕΪ ΔΕ ΖΗ-
ΠΕΚΖΗΤ · —

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ΧΕΠΕΤΑΥΚΑ-
ΠΕΖΟΥΘ ΝΑΥ ΕΒΟΛ
ΠΕ · —

ΒΙΩ ΠΤΑΤΕΣΖΙΝΕ
ΜΕ ΠΟΥΚΟΥΪ ΕΠΙ-
ΔΗ ΑΣΜΕΤΑΝΟΪ
ΠΟΥΝΟΣ · †ΠΑ-
ΕΤΟΥΝΟΣ ΠΝΑ-
ΠΗΜΑΣ · ΑΣΟΥ-
ΦΩΣ ΠΤΕΣΠΡΟ-
ΖΑΪΡΕΣΙΣ ΕΒΟΛ
ΑΠΟΚ ΖΩ †ΠΑ-
ΟΥΦΩΣ ΕΒΟΛ
ΠΠΑΝΑ ΕΖΟΥΪ
ΕΡΟΣ · —

ΑΥΚΟΤΗ ΔΕ ΕΤΕΣ-
ΖΙΜΕ · ΠΕΧΛΗ Η-
ΣΙΜΩΝ · ΧΕ-
ΚΝΑΥ ΕΤΕΪΣΖΙΜΕ ·
ΠΑΪ ΡΩΦΕ Ε-
ΡΟΣ ΗΜΑΤΕ ΕΤΚ-
ΒΟ ΗΜΟΣ · —

ΚΝΑΥ ΠΕΧΛΗ ΕΤΕΪ-
ΣΖΙΜΕ · ΑΝΟΚ
†ΠΑΥ ΕΠΕΣΣΑΝ-
ΖΟΥΗ · —

ΑΝΟΚ †ΟΒΩΡΕΪ Η-
ΠΕΤΕΣΜΕ ΠΖΗ-
ΤΟΥ · —

ΠΤΟΚ ΕΚΩΦΩΤ
ΕΝΑΡΧΑΙΟΗ ·

ΑΝΟΚ ΔΕ ΒΙ† ΗΖ-
ΤΗΪ ΕΤΜΕΤΑΝΟΪΑ · —

ΠΕΤΖΗΠΕΧΕ ΟΥ-
ΣΩΠΤ ΗΒΡΕΠΕ ·
ΑΥΩ ΑΥΡΤΩΡ-
ΠΕ ΝΑΣ ΚΑΤΑ ΠΕΤ-
ΠΡΑΪΠΕΪ · —

ΠΕΤΠΑ†ΠΕΧΟΥ-
ΟΪ ΓΑΡ ΕΡΟΪ · ΦΑΪΛ-
ΑΥ ΗΒΡΕ · —

ΖΩΣΤΕ ΠΕΤΖΗ-
ΠΕΧΕ ΟΥΣΩΠΤ
ΗΒΡΕΠΕ · —

ΟΥΒΡΕΠΕ ΠΚΩ
ΕΚΟΛ ΗΤΗΝΤ-
*ΦΗΖΤΗΥ · ΕΤ-
ΦΟΟΠ ΕΚΟΛ ΣΙΤΟ-
ΟΤΥ · —

ΠΕΡΕΠΠΟΥΤΕ ΓΑΡ
ΖΗΠΕΧΕ · ΕΥΖΩΤΗ
ΝΑΥ ΜΠΚΟΣΜΟΣ ·
ΗΨΩΠ ΑΝ ΕΡΟΥ
ΠΠΕΥΝΟΒΕ · —

ΑΪΕΪ ΕΖΟΥΗ ΕΠΕΚ-
ΗΪ · ΜΠΕΚ†ΜΟ-
ΟΥ ΝΑΪ ΒΕΪΛΡΑΤ ·
ΤΑΪ ΔΕ ΑΣΖΕ ΠΠΕΣ-
ΡΜΕΪΘΟΥΕ · ΑΥΩ
ΑΣΒΟΤΟΥ ΖΗΠΕΣ-
ΚΩ · —

ΜΠΕΚ†ΠΕΪ ΕΡΩΪ ·
ΤΑΪ ΔΕ ΧΪΝΤΑΪ-
ΒΪ ΕΖΟΥΗ · ΜΠΕΣΧΟ
ΕΣ†ΠΕΪ ΕΝΛΟΥΕ-
ΡΗΤΕ · —

ΜΠΕΚΤΕΖΕΤΑΛΠΕ
ΗΝΕΖ · ΤΑΪ ΔΕ
ΑΣΤΕΖΕΝΑΟΥΕΡΗ-
ΤΕ ΠΣΟΒΗ · —

ΜΗ ΑΝΟΚ ΟΥΔΙΚΑΣ-
ΤΗΣ ΑΝΟΚ ΝΑΛΪ-

ΚΟΣ · ΠΕΧΛΗ
ΠΕΠΠΟΥΤΕ · —

ΜΗ ΑΠΟΓΚΡΙΤΗΣ
ΑΝ ΝΑΙΚΑΪΟΣ ·
ΦΑΪ†ΖΑΣ ΓΑΡ Η-
ΒΕΚΗ ΖΑΟΥΒΕΚΗ
ΠΟΥΩΤ · —

ΣΩΥ ΓΑΡ ΠΕΪΤΑ-
ΜΗΤΦΗΖΤΗΥ ·
ΠΖΟΥΘ ΕΤΕΪΡΟΖΕ-
ΡΕΣΙΣ ΠΠΕΤ† Η-
ΠΕΥΟΥΟΪ ΕΡΟΪ · —

ΣΩΤΗ ΕΤΑΜΗΤ-
ΡΕΥ†ΒΕΚΗ ΕΤΡΟ-
ΟΥΤ · ΤΑΡΕΚ-
ΠΑΥ ΕΠΒΕΚΗ · ΧΕ-
ΪΚΗΒ ΠΖΑΣ Η-
ΚΩΒ · —

ΑΝΟΚΠΕ ΠΟΥΟΒΗ
ΠΤΑΪΕΪ · ΕΧΗ ΒΠ-
ΚΑΚΕ ΠΠΛΑΘΟΣ · —

ΑΝΟΚΠΕ ΤΠΟΥΤΗ
ΗΜΟΥ ΠΩΠΗ ·

ΠΤΑΪΕΪ ΕΤΣΟ ΠΠΕ-
ΤΟΒΕ · ΕΒΟΛ ΖΗ-
ΠΣΩΦΗ ΠΠΟΤΟ-
ΒΕ · —

ΑΝΟΚΠΕ ΠΕΣ†-
ΠΟΥΒΕ ΠΠΟΝΤΟΗ ·

*Fol. 53 B
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ΕΙΤΕ ΠΕΤΠΟΡ-
 ΠΕΥΕ ΗΣΛΗ · ΜΑ-
 ΡΕΥΕΠΟΥΛΛΕ-
 ΗΧΙΠΠΟΥ ΕΤΕΒΕ-
 ΖΕΝΚΟΥΕ : —

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ΠΕΤΠΩΡΗ ΗΣΛΗ ·
 ΜΑΡΕΠΟΥΧΕ Ε-
 ΚΟΛ ΗΝΕΤΕΝΟΥ-
 ΝΕ · ΠΕΤΧΟ-
 ΣΕ ΗΝΤ ΕΚΗ · ΕΥ-
 ΜΟΩΣΕ ΖΗΠΗΤ
 ΠΤΕΥΣΑΡ · ΜΑ-
 ΡΕΥΕΙ ΣΑΠΠΟΕ-
 ΝΕΘ ΗΝΕΤΟΚ-
 ΕΙΝΥ ΕΡΟΧ : —

ΠΕΤΠΩΡΗ ΗΝΟΥΧ
 ΜΑΡΕΥΣΤΟΧ ·
 ΧΙΠΤΕΠΟΥ Ε-
 ΖΑΡΕ ΕΠΟΥΕΣ-
 ΣΑΝΕ ΗΝΕΓΡΑ-
 ΦΗ · ΖΩΣΤΕ
 ΕΜΗΠΩΡΚ ΕΠ-
 ΤΗΡ · ΛΥΩ ΤΑΙ-
 ΤΕ ΘΕ ΕΤΕΤΗΝΑ-
 ΟΥΠΕ ΠΟΥΡΩ-
 ΝΕ ΗΤΕΛΙΟΣ : —

ΑΜΗΤΗ Ω ΠΤΑΓ-
 ΜΑ ΤΗΡΟΥ · ΗΤΕ-
 ΤΙΚΩΣ ΕΤΗΕΤΑ-
 ΝΟΙΑ ΗΤΕΙΣΙΝΕ : —

ΟΥΡΩΝΕ ΕΥΧΛ-
 ΖΗ · ΖΗΤΕΥΚΑ-

ΤΑΣΤΑΣΙΣ ΗΦΟΡΗ ·
 ΜΑΡΕΥΣΠΟΥΛΛ-
 ΖΕ ΤΕΠΟΥ · ΗΡ-
 ΤΟΥΧΕΖΕΝΚΟΥΕ
 ΖΗΤΗΕΤΑΝΟΙΑ ·
 ΗΤΕΙΣΙΝΕ ΗΡΕΥ-
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 ΖΗΤ ΕΠΛΥ · ΕΩΛΗ
 ΕΚΟΛ ΗΤΕΙΠΡΟΣ-

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 ΗΦΟΥΩ ΗΕΠΩΣΕ

ΗΦΩΧΗ ΗΕΠΗ-
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 ΤΕ ΗΤΩΝ · ΗΘΕ
 ΗΤΑΓΛΙΣ ΕΡΟΧ
 ΑΣΠΑΡΑΚΑΛΕΙ Η-
 ΜΟΧ · ΧΕΑΣΣΕ ΕΤΕΥ-
 ΚΕΡΙΛ : —

ΠΕΧΛΑΚ ΧΕΑΣΠΑΡΑ-
 ΚΑΛΕΙ ΗΝΟΧ ΕΣ-
 ΖΗΧΗΚΑΣ ΗΗ-
 ΜΑΧ · ΜΗ ΕΡΟ-

ΠΠΟΥΤΕ ΟΥΝΥ Η-
 ΜΟΚ ΗΤΟΚ ΕΚ-
 ΟΥΑΠΑΡΑΚΑΛΕΙ
 ΗΜΟΥ : —

ΠΠΟΥΤΕ ΓΑΡ ΟΥΝΖ
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 ΗΚΑΙΡΟΣ ΗΙΜ ·

ΛΥΩ ΦΟΥΝΣ ΖΗ-
 ΠΕΚΖΗΤ ΕΚΦΑΗ-
 ΟΥΠΗ ΕΡΟΚ : —

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ΕΙΣ ΤΗΝΤΕΡΟ ΓΑΡ
 ΜΠΟΥΤΕ · ΜΑ-
 ΡΕΠΗ ΜΠΕΠΟΥΟΙ
 ΕΖΟΥΗ ΕΠΕΟΥΣΙ-
 ΑΣΤΗΡΙΟΝ · ΗΜΑ
 ΗΠΕΟΥΕΡΙΤΕ ΗΠ-
 ΠΟΥΤΕ : —

ΜΑΡΕΝΣΩΛΕ ΕΤΕΤ-
 ΡΑΠΕΛΑ ΕΤΟΥΛ-
 ΛΕ : —

ΜΑΡΕΠΩΡΩ Ε-
 ΚΟΛ ΗΠΕΠΕΙΧ ·
 ΜΠΠΕΠΗΤ —

ΖΑΠΛΑ ΖΑΠΛΩΣ ·
 ΜΑΡΕΠΕΙ ΗΤΕΠ-
 ΨΥΧΗ ΤΗΡΣ ΕΣ-
 ΡΑΙ ΠΑΖΡΗΠΟΥ-
 ΤΕ · ΕΠΗΛΑ ΗΠ-

ΣΟΒΗ ΜΑΡΕΠΗ ΠΛ
 ΗΠΕΣΨ ΠΟΥΒΕ ·
 ΗΤΕΠΗΡΟΖΑΙ-
 ΡΕΣΙΣ : —

ΕΠΗΛΑ ΗΠΑΛΛ-
 ΚΑΣΤΡΟΝ · ΕΤΕ-

ρεῖσων ἡντην
μαρεν† παλ ἡν-
τεσο ἡνεντη : —

* Fol. 31 r
[15] * ἐνθαλῆσθ γὰρ
ἐβλα ἡνεογέ-
ρητε ἡνεκ-
τα · αὐτὸ ἡ-

τενμαλασσὲ ἡ-
νεσαρῆ ἡνετ-
ωσνε · ἀν-
κῆνε ἡννε-
ἡτενεί· ἀν-
εαρος ἡνεῖ-
ἡνυ ἡνκε ·
ἡτενφωτ ὁ-
βλα ἡνενο-
εὐ ἐτχαλῆ ·

ἡτενχίσε ἐβλαῖ
ἡννεβγέ ἡ-
πεντη : —

ἡτενκω ἐβλαῖ
ἡνκαρπος
ἡνμετανεῖ —

αὐτὸ ἡτεῖσε ·
τενμασῶτη
ὁτεῖσμη · ἐτῆ-
ἡφα ἡνκω
ἐβλα · χε-
ἡτεῖσνε
κῆ ἡντη ὁ⁽¹⁾
εὐλα : —

→
αὐτὸ χετῶτη-
ἡεῖς · τε-
τανεῖσμη-
τη : —

→
Γενοῦτοσε ὁ
ἡμερῶτε ἡ-
νεμῶτη-
στην ἡπνοῦ-
τε · ἡν-
γὰρ τηρῆ · ἐν-
κω ἡτην
ἐπενη : —

→
αὐτὸ ἐνθεαπῆ-
ζε ἐτῆσμη-
στην · ἐβλα
εἰτοῦτη : —

→
αὐτὸ ἐρεῖνα
γὰρ · ἡνῖσ-
τε · αὐτὸ
πενῖσμη
ἡτοῦτη : —

→
εἰτητεχαρῆς ·
ἡντη-
ἡλῶνε · ἡ-
πενχοῖς · αὐτὸ
πεννοῦτε ·
πενσῶτηρ
ἡ πεχῶ ·

[21]
* Παῖ βλα εἰτό-
οτη · ἐρεῖσ-
ἡν πρεπῆ-
ἡλ · ἡνπε-
εἶωτ ἡαλαος
ἡνπεπῆλ ὁ-
τοῦλα · ἡ-
ρεβταντο ἡν-

τηρῆ · αὐτὸ ἡ-
ενοοῦσῶν ·
τενοῦ · αὐτὸ
νοῦοῖω ἡν
οἡαλῶν ·
τηροῦ · ἡπαῖ-
ωπ σαμῆν : —

* Fol. 35 r
12

THE TRANSLATION

* A Discourse which Apa John (Iôhannês), the Archbishop of Constantinople (Kôstantinoupolis), pronounced concerning the sinful woman who repented, when she sought Jesus in the house of the Pharisee, (and) He granted to her the remission of her sins; exhorting everyone unto repentance and (saying) that man shall not accomplish lawlessness; in the peace of God. Amen.

Come ye whose flowers have withered by the fruitlessness of the *passions* which scorch them, that ye may weave for yourselves crowns from the grove of the Gospel. Come ye whose lamps have been extinguished by the mist of darkness of ungodliness, that ye may take oil unto yourselves from the oil of repentance. Come, O ye who are troubled by the storm of *passions*, that ye may make yourselves firm by the anchor of the Gospel. Seek ye, without fear, after repentance. Prepare ye the way in firmness. Cause not anyone to delay in seeking* after repentance. Be not ashamed that thou hast sinned. Great is the mercifulness⁽¹⁾ of God more than thy sins. Say not that I am drowned in ungodliness, for there is a ship which hath been brought up after having been sunk.

Everything which is zealously undertaken is wont to be completed uprightly. For zeal followeth resolution. For the love of man⁽²⁾ surpasseth repentance. It (love of man) seeketh the houses of them who are sick; it healeth them. It seeketh the places of them who mourn, comforting

* Fol. 36 v

⁽¹⁾ *See*.

⁽¹⁾ The Coptic has the plural. ⁽²⁾ i. e. God's love for man.

them. It giveth *soothing* (παιδια). It *healeth* the eyes which are clouded by *evil*. It changeth the earth which was salted into a perfect field producing *fruit*.

We shall not prolong any more in speaking at the *beginning*. Come that we may say to you what hath been now proclaimed, that we may manifest to you the power of *repentance*, or rather that we may point out to you God's love of man.

One of the Pharisees besought Him that He should eat with him. Man entresth God, the created beggeth the Creator to come to his house; God eateth with man. The *Maker of the world* eateth with the sinner that He may call sinners to *repentance*. God refrained not from entering into the house of the sinner on account of whom He Himself came. And He entered into the house of the Pharisee (and) reclined. God entered into the house of man, but what was in the house of man that was not His? He Who nourisheth all (creation) ate a small quantity of *food*. He to Whom the *angels minister*, the servants of the Pharisee ministered to Him. It is not the Pharisee who is the lover of man and God, but it is God Who is *philanthropic* to all (creation). Man setteth forth victuals, but it is God Who hath prepared them. Come ye, that ye may seek after the great *treasure* which is to me a wall, namely, *repentance*.

And lo, a woman, a sinner is in the city. When she knew that He was reclining in the house of the Pharisee, she thought within herself, saying: "What shall I do?" Also again the fear of my unworthiness hindereth me. I wish to entreat the Lord concerning my sins, but my lawlessness impedeth me (to approach) God, because by what shall I entreat Him, or by what shall I be justified before Him? My *resolution* is darkened to me. The weight of my sins produceth much evil odour. I have no tongue to *confess* my sins to God. The *depth* (πλάτος) of my *ungodliness* is great. I have no confidence to approach Him on account of my sins. I shall go, perhaps He may not be unmindful of me and my *sacrifice*. If I go not unto Him, I shall not have mercy, what, then, shall I do? What shall I do and take, when I go unto God? I shall take the *source* of the tears of my eyes, that I may moisten the feet of His compassion. My plaited hair which is beauty unto me, I shall wipe the feet of His Divinity with it.

* Fol. 27 r

* Fol. 27 v

And she took an *alabaster-box* of ointment of great price. Exceeding great is thy *resolution*. For small is the vow which thou hast performed, (but) great is the forgiveness of God.

"Lo, this is the blessing which the woman prepared, when about to go unto the Lord. She was forgetful of her *fornication*, (and) she *cleansed* the evil state in which she was. And these were (the things) she was thinking, as she was about to go unto Him. She said: "I have defiled myself. I have washed away my defilement through the *source* of my tears. I shall cleave to Him through my *resolution*. I hope that He will not cast me out. This is the time, as long as I am in the body. If I neglect (it), I shall draw down upon myself a heavy burden which it (will) not (be) possible for me to bear. The unquenchable fire (and) the sleepless worm, these (are the things) which befall those who shall die in their sins. I shall entreat with my tears; perhaps, I shall remove the *threat of punishments*."

* Fol. 28 r

She sought (Him) immediately; she remained behind Him, beneath His feet, weeping. She did not approach more, her *resolution*, as it were, preventing her from remaining behind Him and beneath His feet. What then is it that the woman will do? From the eyes which she wearieth in *pleasure*, she poured down a multitude of tears.* We have seen the woman's advance. Thou beholdest her high *resolution*. See the heart-break and the mourning and the sorrow of her *soul*, for how much *passion* did she suppress? In the place of wantonness and laughing, whence found this (woman) *soul-break*? This sadness came through *repentance*. Thou seest that wantonness and dissoluteness are wont to be in *pleasure*. See, also, the quietness and the *settled condition* which are wont to exist through *repentance*.

* Fol. 28 v

She remained behind Him, at His feet, weeping. She began to drench His feet with her tears. This is the *beginning of perception*. This is the motion of the *soul* towards *repentance*. This is the *beginning* of the manifestation of *resolution*. The tears flow down upon her cheeks with *groaning*. She had no confidence to speak or to open her mouth. But she was persisting greatly in misery, *groaning* and * weeping.

* Fol. 29 r

For the *soul* which shall seek after God in truth, is not wont to be ashamed, if (a) man see it weeping (and) smiting its breast, because of

the multitude (of the sins) which it hath committed, plucking out its hair. It is wont to support blame with *threat(s)*, being humble. If it is *threatened*, it is not wont to be wroth, but the evil are wont to *punish* it. It is wont to blame itself alone. It is wont to blame its *conscience*.

It is wont to say « I am worthy of every suffering. Perhaps, through this, I shall lessen a little my *transgressions* ».

And this is the sign that man hath turned from his sins, when he support upbraidings lightly. Those who object to blame are as a senseless (man), and as he who wavereth and is disturbed in all his ways⁽¹⁾. If thou marvel at her seeking after God, marvel rather at God's love for man.

* Fol. 29 v^o She began to drench His feet; she wiped them with the hair of her head. God Himself⁽²⁾ wiped out her sin through His great mercy, and He wiped (out) the *handwriting* (against her)⁽³⁾. Which, then, of these two is worthy to be admired? I think God's pitifulness of heart is what layeth hold of me more. This (woman) began to drench His feet with her tears, and to wipe them with her hair. She was kissing His feet; anointing them with ointment.

The Pharisee saw Him, when He was invited; he said within himself: « If this (man) were a *prophet*, He would have known of what kind she is, that she is a sinner. O Simon, thy foolishness hath corrupted thy ways. When thou didst blame God, thy *Maker of the World*, in thy heart, didst thou then not have pity on this woman, did not the sobbing of her tears move thee, and wast thou not confused on account of her groaning? God the Sinless (One) hath pity on sinners who weep. Art thou pitiless, thou (who) art a sinner?

* Fol. 30 r^o He said: « If this (man) were a *prophet*, He would have known what manner⁽⁴⁾ of woman this is who touched Him, that she is a sinner. O Simon, didst thou know that He was a *prophet* only? He is God and the Lord of *prophets*. Fear Him Who reclineth in thy house. Cure thyself from *envy*. Why didst thou not blame thine own self, because God made thee worthy, (and) He entered into thy house? Why didst

⁽¹⁾ Cf. James I, 8*. ⁽²⁾ Lit. 'bec handwriting'.

thou not have⁽¹⁾ the *faith* of the *centurion*? « If this (man) were a *prophet*, He would have known what she was », he said, « and of what kind she was »⁽²⁾.

« O Simon, do I not know the sins of this (woman) and⁽³⁾ do I not know thine? Is there anything towards which I am not *longsuffering*, except the *wretchedness* of a sinner? Do I not perceive the *iniquities* which are committed in the whole world? Thou *speakest against* the woman, because thou knowest her sins which are manifest. O Simon, I *behold* those which are hidden and those which are manifest, and My *longsuffering* hath *endured* them all. I desire not the death⁽⁴⁾ of these who shall die⁽⁵⁾, as that he should turn from his evil way and live⁽⁶⁾. Know, then, O Simon, that there is nothing hidden from Me, and that I am not come to call the *righteous*, but sinners to *repentance*⁽⁷⁾. I have a word to say to thee, O Simon ». He said to Him, « Say it, Teachers⁽⁸⁾ ».

* Fol. 30 v^o

Thou hast seen this speech full of *hypocrisy*. Generations of serpents and children of the serpents, the *race* which is counted unto *wickedness*, those who sit in the *seat* of Moses, while they are enemies of Moses in their deeds. And why didst thou not say: « My Lord and My God? » But he said: « Master ». He is well caught on account of his restraint. And thou numberest Him with Nicodemus and Gamaliel and all your scribes. For thou art wont to find *hypocrisy* in what the eyes of their heart consider as *wickedness*. Why didst thou not say, as Peter the *Apôtre*, « Master and Lord »? For He would have said in thy presence that thou sayest *well*, for I am. For, *assuredly*, out of the abundance⁽⁹⁾ of the heart the mouth is wont to speak⁽¹⁰⁾.

* Fol. 31 r^o

Hearken also to Christ Who is full of the mercy of God. He said: « Two men were in debt to a *creditor*. One owed him five hundred *staters*, the other, fifty. He forgave them both. Which of them is he who will love him the more? »⁽¹¹⁾ Indeed, I came into the world to bear the sins of the world. I shall purify the *magicians* to make them sinless; to make *robbers* members of the household of *Paradise*. And, indeed, it is

⁽¹⁾ Lit. 'accept'. ⁽²⁾ Cf. Luke, VII, 39. ⁽³⁾ x c n e. l a g. ⁽⁴⁾ S c. ⁽⁵⁾ Cf. Esak. XVIII, 23*. ⁽⁶⁾ Luke V, 32*. ⁽⁷⁾ Luke, VII, 40*. ⁽⁸⁾ Cf. Math. XII, 34*.

⁽⁹⁾ Cf. Luke VII, 41-42.

needful that my pity should attain to the others who are in Amēte. Shall I then forget also the ⁽¹⁾ wretchedness of this ⁽²⁾ sinner (and) prostitute? Nay, I shall tear up the writing against her and I shall send her away to her house a virgin.

* Fel. 31 v

I am the salt. I came into the world, salting the salt which had become insipid through the iniquities of the ⁽³⁾ people [who] ever sought Me, being defiled, and not purified. Before this woman sought Me, she was defiled, and immediately that she touched Me, My Divinity attained to her. He who cometh unto Me, defiled, is wont* to depart from Me, purified. Lo, thy tongue, O Simon, hath confessed that to whom much is forgiven it is fitting for him to love much. Indeed, thou judgest rightly with thy mouth, but thou speakest evil in thy heart.* «I think», said he (Simon), «he to whom much was forgiven⁽⁴⁾». If the woman love a little, for as much as she hath repented, I shall perform great mercy to her. She hath spread forth her resolution; I, also, shall spread forth My mercy unto her.*

* Fel. 32 r

And He turned to the woman (and) said to Simon: «Thou seest this woman. This greatly sufficeth unto her to purify her.» He said: «Thou seest this woman; I see her inner part. I behold that by which she expresseth her love. Thou lookest at (the things) which are antiquated, but I gave heed to repentances, — he who is in Christ is a new creature⁽⁵⁾ — and He began with her according to what is fitting, for he who shall seek Me, I am wont to renew him, — so that he who is in Christ may be a new creature⁽⁶⁾. (What is) new is the forgiveness out of the* pity which existeth through Him. For God was in Christ reconciling the world to Him(self), [and] He doth not account to them their sins⁽⁷⁾».

«I came into thine house, thou gavest Me not water to wash My feet, but this (woman) hath (let) fall her tears, and hath wiped them (My feet) with her hair. Thou kissest not My mouth, but this (woman), since the time I came in hath not ceased to kiss My feet. Thou anointest not My head with oil, but this (woman) hath anointed My feet with oint-

⁽¹⁾ The Coptic has «this». ⁽²⁾ The Coptic has «the». ⁽³⁾ Cf. Luke VII, 43*. ⁽⁴⁾ Cf. II Cor. V, 17*, 2. ⁽⁵⁾ Cf. II Cor. V, 17*, 2. ⁽⁶⁾ Cf. II Cor. V, 19*.

ment⁽¹⁾». «Is it (that) I (Who) am a judge, am unjust?» saith God. «Am I not a just judge, because I am wont to give many wages for a single wage?» For My pity is much greater than the resolution of them who seek Me.

Hearken to My eager awarding of wages that thou mayest see that the wage is doubled many fold. I am the light and I have come upon the darkness of passions. I am the source of living water and I have come to give to drink to them who thirst with the exhaustion of them who thirst. I am the rational sweet odour, and I have come to bear away the stench of the iniquity of the world. «I shall snatch away this ignorant lamb also from the beast, and I shall heal it and return it unto the spiritual sheep-fold.

* Fel. 32 v

This woman hath drenched My feet with her tears, I also shall wash her soul in the water of repentance, and I shall burn away her sins in the fire of My Divinity. She hath kissed My feet; I shall make her worthy of the holy dispensation. She wiped My feet, I shall wipe out her sins from the book of the accusers and I shall write her in the register⁽²⁾ of life. She hath anointed My feet with ointment, I shall give to her the spiritual Eucharist, and grant to her life, and I shall receive her into the store-house of life which is in the heavens before My Father.

Thou hast seen My awarding of wages, as I snatch the souls of the sinners from punishments unto life. Thou hast seen how great is My love of man; her⁽³⁾ last departed immediately, (and her) wickednesses were forgotten. The physician of pleasure hath yielded (and) nothing, then, is seen except repentance. The places of darkness* have become weak here; Amēte which is darkened hath been loosed; the fear which is in that place hath ceased; the fire of Gehenna is stilled; the gate of the Palace is open. Heaven hath received the soul of sinners. None now beareth malice. None now maketh a distinction. Arise ye, then, seek now

* Fel. 33 r

⁽¹⁾ Cf. Luke VII, 44-46.

⁽²⁾ Matriga. sic. Read, probably, ματρίκιον (Latin Matricula), roll, register, list, cf. E. A. SOPHOCLES, Greek Lexicon of the Roman and Byzantine Periods, New York, 1900 [O. H. E. KHS-Burmesler].

⁽³⁾ Lit. «the».

repentance, and ye shall all receive *proof* of My pity. On account of this, I say to thee, that her sins which are many are forgiven to her, because she loved greatly⁽¹⁾. The power of forgiveness which she received was not *according to* (the fact) that she loved much, *but* it was the inscrutable gift of God.

This woman, a sinner, *hath encouraged* everyone to *repentance*. He who is in Christ is a new creature⁽²⁾. Let us put off the old man and his works and seek after the new man who hath been created *according to* God, making *peace*⁽³⁾. And if any⁽⁴⁾ were practising fornication yesterday, let him *hasten* from to-day to purify* others. He who robbed yesterday, let him discard his own things. He who is proud-hearted *without a cause*, walking with the heart⁽⁵⁾ of his *flesh*, let him support the reproach of those who are humbler than he. He who sweareth falsely, let him turn from now to keep the commandment of the *Scriptures*, so as not to swear at all, and this is the manner (in) which ye shall become a *perfect man*.

O come all ye *rank*s, that ye may emulate the *repentance* of this woman. Let a man (who was) formerly defiled in his *state*, *hasten* now and save others through the *repentance* of this woman, a sinner. Let all men be zealous for their wives in (this) *way*; let every woman learn modesty; let every youth (who) is in the *stage* of his childhood learn to be a wise man; let every *rank* be taught *simply* from this woman to (?) deal with the members of the household who burn after her manner.

Seize⁽⁶⁾ the *occasion* without being double-minded; and display this *resolution*, as long as we are in* this *life*, before our feet stumble by reason of the mountains of darkness; before the summer is past, and the reaping ceaseth, and the harvest is over, and everyone crieth with a loud voice. But thou hast said, 'Where shall I find God?', as this (woman) found Him? She *brought* Him, and she found the *occasion*.

Thou hast said that she *brought* Him, while she was on the earth with Him. Will God be far from thee, if thou *beneechest* Him? For God

⁽¹⁾ Cf. Luke VII, 47*. ⁽²⁾ Cf. II Cor. V, 17*. ⁽³⁾ Cf. Col. III, 9, 10*. ⁽⁴⁾ Lit. 'be who'. ⁽⁵⁾ Sic. ⁽⁶⁾ Lit. 'run to'.

abideth in the *Church* at all *times*, and He abideth in thy heart, if thou accept Him. For behold the Kingdom of God! Let us advance unto the *altar*, the foot-stool of God. Let us embrace the *Holy Table*. Let us stretch out our hands and our hearts.

Once and for all, let us offer up our whole *soul* before God. In the place of ointment, let us give to Him the good odour of our *resolution*. In the place of the *alabaster-box* in which was the ointment, let us give to Him the purity of our heart. *For if we wash the feet of the *widows* and we *relieve* the *flesh* of him who is sick with the sweetness of oil, and we support the *heaviness* of our poor brethren, and we flee from our polluting sins, (and) we lift up the thought of our heart, and we set forth the *fruit* of *repentance*, we shall on this wise hear this voice to which it appertaineth to forgive, saying 'Your sins are forgiven to you, and it is your *faith* which hath saved you'.

* Fol. 34 v.

May it so be, then, O my beloved, through the compassion of God. For we all trust to His mercy, and we *hope* in compassion⁽¹⁾ from Him, for mercy and salvation and visitation (are) from Him.

Through the *grace* and the love of man of Our Lord and Our God and Our Saviour Jesus Christ *through Whom all honour is *due* unto Him and His Good Father and the Holy Spirit, the Lifegiver of all, and *Consubstantial*, now, and at all times, (and) unto all the *ages* of the *ages* Amen.

* Fol. 35 v.

⁽¹⁾ Lit. 'His Compassion'.